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Correct Answer

Next Question

Practice Exam - 1

Question 100 of 117



Which patient is the best candidate for initiation of ivabradine?

- A.** 55-year-old man with NYHA functional class II HF (LVEF of 60%) and heart rate 75 beats/minute taking lisinopril 20 mg daily and carvedilol 25 mg twice daily for hypertension.
- B.** 45-year-old man with NYHA functional class II HF (LVEF of 35%) and heart rate 62 beats/minute taking lisinopril 40 mg daily, metoprolol succinate 150 mg daily, and spironolactone 25 mg daily.
- C.** 65-year-old woman with NYHA functional class III HF (LVEF of 20%) with heart rate 78 beats/minute taking lisinopril 20 mg daily, eplerenone 50 mg daily, and carvedilol 25 mg twice daily.
- D.** 58-year old man with NYHA functional class IV HF (LVEF of 10%) with heart rate 110 beats/minute receiving outpatient dobutamine therapy and awaiting transplantation.

Commentary

References

Testing Point: The Board-certified AHFTC specialist should have an understanding of appropriate populations to initiate GDMT in patients with HFrEF.

Correct Answer: C. 65-year-old woman with NYHA functional class III HF (LVEF of 20%) with heart rate 78 beats/minute taking lisinopril 20 mg daily, eplerenone 50 mg daily, and carvedilol 25 mg twice daily.

Rationale: According to current heart failure guidelines, ivabradine is indicated in patients with symptomatic HFrEF (LVEF $\leq 35\%$) who are in sinus rhythm with a resting heart rate ≥ 70 beats/minute despite maximally tolerated β -blocker therapy to reduce heart failure hospitalization.

According to data from the SHIFT trial, the ideal candidate for ivabradine is a patient with HFrEF and NYHA functional class II or III symptoms who meets these criteria.

Answer C is correct because this patient has symptomatic HFrEF (LVEF 20%), NYHA functional class III symptoms, a resting heart rate of 78 beats/minute, and is receiving a maximally tolerated dose of carvedilol, making her an appropriate candidate for ivabradine.

Answer A is incorrect because this patient has HFpEF. The EDIFY trial found that heart rate reduction with ivabradine did not improve outcomes, and current evidence does not support its use in HFpEF.

Answer B is incorrect because although the patient has HFrEF, the resting heart rate is only 62 beats/minute, which does not meet criteria for ivabradine initiation.

Answer D is incorrect because ivabradine is not indicated in patients with NYHA class IV heart failure requiring continuous inotropic support. Additionally, the elevated heart rate is likely attributable to dobutamine therapy rather than intrinsic sinus tachycardia.

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